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Counting continues

...Electoral Commission of Zambia lifts suspension on counting; first results due tonight

(Page 2)

Macky 2 concedes defeat

By Alex Maboshe

Mulaza Kaira, popularly known as Macky 2, has conceded defeat in the Nchanga parliamentary election, accepting the outcome with faith and viewing it as a possible redirection in his journey of service.

In a post-election message, Kaira said, "I really do not understand God's timing right now, but I trust Him completely.

His plan over my life always turns out better than what I initially want." He thanked his campaign team and urged supporters not to be discouraged.

"Our mission was never just about a title. It was about service... there are still countless ways we can do that, with or without a seat in Parliament. The work continues."

Kaira congratulated winner Rosemary Chipoya on a decent campaign and wished her success, noting that all sides want progress, unity and development for Nchanga.

Addressing residents, he pledged, "This place isn't just a constituency to me, it's my home and I will never stop fighting for you. Let's remain united... Our best days are still ahead of us."

He has received messages of support from fellow artists and his wife, Hantinga Kaira, who said she was proud of his efforts and sacrifices, believed everything happens for a reason, and that their children now have a strong example of self-belief.



Mundubile not arrested - Kawana

(Page 3)

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Real News in Real Time

Ziko Lathu Faults ECZ

By Alex Maboshe

The Ziko Lathu Consortium has raised serious concerns about operational failures, election-day violence, and critical shortages of materials during Zambia's August 13 General Elections.

The group warned that repeated shortcomings risk undermining public confidence as the counting process continues.

In its third preliminary statement, the civil society coalition comprising Action Aid Zambia, MISA Zambia, NGOCC, PANOS, and Young Women in Action—called on electoral authorities and security forces to ensure transparency and protect the integrity of the ongoing vote tabulation.

The consortium reported that widespread disruptions, security threats, and political interference affected voting and the early stages of counting in several monitored

areas.

Specific incidents highlighted include a shooting in Kalomo linked to alleged vote-buying by a former District Commissioner, which left two people injured.

In Chambishi, violent clashes over delayed openings of polling stations led to the complete suspension of voting at Tata Waluse.

Monitors in Kanyama observed political actors harassing voters in queues by demanding to see their voter cards and National Registration Cards.

In Chipata and Muchini, local power outages forced election staff to count ballots in the dark using mobile phone lights.

Observers from the consortium noted that these operational problems mirror failures from the 2021 election cycle and point to inadequate preparation by the Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ).

The group also flagged significant shortages of essential tallying supplies, including missing ballot-sealing envelopes at the University of Zambia and Kabulonga polling stations, as well as a tense standoff after voting closed at UNZA.

The consortium demanded that election authorities transparently account for every legally cast ballot and that police conduct professional investigations into all reports of assault and voter intimidation.

It further urged political actors to avoid premature declarations of victory and to refrain from any actions that could incite violence.

Civil society leaders stressed that strict adherence to electoral procedures and clear, open communication remain essential for securing public acceptance of the final election results.

Zambezi unruly supporters tear gassed

By Alex Maboshe

Tensions were raised today as Police fired tear gas to disperse a crowd of supporters outside the Zambezi Town Council offices amid claims that electoral staff were delivering pre-marked or “pre-rigged” ballot papers.

Word spread that polling officials were bringing in materials allegedly prepared in advance to influence the vote, prompting supporters to gather and demand transparency.

The atmosphere grew charged as people voiced anger over the handling of the papers.

Police intervened with tear gas to break up the group. Reactions were sharply divided.

One supporter, who declined to give his name, said “We are here because we will not accept stolen votes.

If the papers are already marked, then the election is finished before it starts.”

A nearby trader condemned both the alleged irregularities and the police response

“People have a right to raise concerns, but tear gas in the middle of town is dangerous, especially for children and the elderly. We need answers from the electoral body, not chaos.”

Neither the Zambezi Town Council nor the electoral commission has issued

an immediate statement on the allegations.

Police have not detailed how many people were affected or whether any arrests were made.

The incident has heightened tensions around ballot delivery in the region.

Authorities are urging the public to remain calm, report complaints through official channels, and await the outcome of ongoing investigations. Further updates are expected.

Diabetes on the rise, MOH warns

By Alex Maboshe

The Ministry of Health has warned that the growing burden of diabetes across all age groups demands urgent public action, including healthier lifestyles and routine health checks.

Speaking in an interview, Ministry of Health Non-Communicable Diseases Manager Brian Mwachisowa said type 2 diabetes in particular is increasingly being diagnosed among both adults and young people seeking care at health facilities.

He attributed the rise mainly to unhealthy diets high in sugary and processed foods, overweight and obesity, and physical inactivity.

Dr. Mwachisowa urged the public to choose healthier foods, exercise regularly, and avoid habits that elevate the risk of developing the disease.

He also encouraged people to take advantage of

screening services at health facilities, noting that early detection allows treatment to start before the condition damages vital organs.

The Ministry is scaling up health promotion, screening and early diagnosis programmes while improving access to essential diabetes medicines and supplies, he said.

Making healthier choices at every meal, combined with regular physical activity and routine check-ups, can help prevent diabetes and save lives, Dr. Mwachisowa emphasised.

Nutritionist Bright Chibala reinforced the importance of diet, saying improved food choices are critical to lowering diabetes risk.

He called on the public to prioritise nutritious, less processed foods and maintain healthy eating habits as a key part of disease prevention.

Zambeef Mtendere Bakery Sets the Standard for Food Safety and Quality



What began in 2016 as a modest community bakery has grown into a benchmark for quality, safety and operational excellence in Zambia's baking industry.

Established at the end of 2016 during the revitalisation of Zambeef Products Plc's bakery business, Zamloaf Mtendere Bakery was created with a simple but ambitious vision: to provide the Mtendere community with hot, freshly baked bread while adding value to flour produced by Zamflour in Chisamba. The facility was also designed to serve as a test bakery, enabling the business to monitor flour quality and identify any inconsistencies before products reached consumers.

Modelled on the operational standards of a leading retail bakery, the Mtendere facility initially produced a range of baked goods including white and brown bread. Today, the bakery has refined its focus and specialises in producing four premium bread varieties, white bread, milk bread, brown bread and health bread, meeting the evolving needs of customers while maintaining uncompromising quality.

The bakery's latest achievement marks another significant milestone in its journey. Zamloaf Mtendere Bakery has attained an internationally recognised Food Safety Management System certification, ISO 22000, reinforcing its commitment

to producing safe, high-quality baked products that meet both local regulatory requirements and global best practices.

The certification recognises the bakery's robust food safety systems, incorporating Good Manufacturing Practices, hazard analysis, product traceability, effective communication, stringent process controls and strong management oversight. Together, these measures ensure that food safety risks are identified, prevented and controlled at every stage of production, from raw materials through to the finished loaf.

For consumers, the certification provides confidence that every loaf leaving the bakery has been produced under internationally recognised food safety standards. It also demonstrates Zambeef's unwavering commitment to placing customers at the centre of its operations by ensuring that every product is manufactured with consistency, transparency and accountability.

Beyond enhancing consumer confidence, the certification strengthens the bakery's operational performance by embedding a culture of continuous improvement throughout the business. Standardised processes, disciplined documentation and rigorous quality controls improve efficiency while reinforcing

accountability across every stage of production.

The achievement also positions Zamloaf favourably within an increasingly competitive marketplace. By demonstrating compliance with internationally recognised food safety standards, the bakery enhances its credibility among customers, retailers and business partners, creating new opportunities for growth while supporting long-term business sustainability.

As part of the wider Zambeef Products Plc family, Zamloaf complements the company's integrated value chain, which spans dairy, meat, poultry, animal feed, cropping and flour milling. The certification reflects the Group's broader commitment to delivering quality products that consumers can trust while continually investing in systems that strengthen food safety, operational excellence and customer satisfaction.

From its beginnings as a neighbourhood bakery serving fresh bread to the Mtendere community, Zamloaf Mtendere Bakery has evolved into a facility that exemplifies how investment in quality, innovation and internationally recognised standards can build consumer confidence and contribute to the continued growth of Zambia's food manufacturing sector.

Namwala woman gang-raped

By Alex Maboshe

A 34-year-old woman in Namwala District, Southern Province, was allegedly gang-raped by two men known to her on the night of Tuesday, 11 August 2026.

The attack reportedly took place in the Chibunze area and occurred in the presence of the woman's 12-year-old child.

Southern Province Police Commanding Officer Moono Namalongo confirmed the incident.

He said the two suspects

forced their way into the house while the woman and her child were asleep, took turns sexually assaulting her, and then fled the scene.

Mr. Namalongo said the two men remain at large as Police have opened a docket and instituted investigations. Efforts are underway to track down and arrest the suspects.

The case highlights ongoing concerns around gender-based violence in the region.

Police has further urged anyone with information that could assist the investigation to contact the nearest police station.

UN refute congratulating presidential candidate

By Alex Maboshe

The United Nations in Zambia has rejected social media claims that its observers have congratulated a presidential candidate after the 13 August elections, stating it has no electoral observation mandate and deployed no observers.

The organisation said any suggestions that the UN endorsed or commented on a candidate or the outcome are false.

“The United Nations does not observe national electoral processes unless mandated by the General Assembly or the Security Council... it does

not pronounce itself on the validity of an electoral process or the legitimacy of electoral outcomes,” said Resident Coordinator Beatrice Mutali.

The UN condemned the misuse of its emblems, urged the public and media to verify information through official channels, and called on leaders and supporters to uphold the peace pledge and reject violence while awaiting results.

The official results for the 2026 General election are yet to be announced and the Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ) has cautioned all stakeholders against circulating non official information

By Ruth Kambita

The Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ) has lifted its temporary suspension of counting and announcing election results after security threats against polling staff and electoral materials were contained, ECZ chairperson Mwangala Zaloumis announced today.

Early this afternoon the Commission halted counting nationwide following reports of violence against poll workers and incidents of theft of marked ballot papers and ballot boxes. The suspension, the ECZ said at the time, would

Counting continues

be reviewed within 24 hours depending on the security situation.

Following consultations with law enforcement agencies, Ms Zaloumis told the nation that the security threat had been addressed and that measures are now in place to allow counting and results management to resume.

She said polling was successfully conducted at all polling stations, with the last

station closing in the early hours of today.

“The suspension of the counting and announcement of results has been lifted with immediate effect,” Ms Zaloumis said. The Commission will release its first set of results at 22:00 tonight.

As counting resumes, the ECZ appealed to political parties, candidates and members of the public to remain peaceful and to allow poll staff to

perform their duties without interference, intimidation or violence.

The Commission stressed that the safety of poll staff, security of electoral materials and integrity of the process remain paramount, and said law enforcement agencies will continue to provide security to ensure counting proceeds in a peaceful and orderly manner.

The ECZ reminded all

stakeholders that only the Commission may officially announce election results under prescribed procedures.

Ms Zaloumis cited Section 89(1) of the Electoral Process Amendment Act No. 32 of 2021, warning that any person who, without lawful authority, declares election results is committing an offence.

She urged candidates and parties to refrain from prematurely declaring victory and to

allow the Commission to fulfill its constitutional mandate of counting, verifying and announcing results.

Ms Zaloumis thanked Zambians for their patience and cooperation, commended law enforcement agencies for maintaining order and expressed appreciation to poll staff for their commitment. She said the Commission will continue to update the nation as the process progresses.

Mundubile not arrested

By Ruth Kambita

Information and Media Permanent Secretary Thabo Kawana has dispelled reports that National Reconciliation Party for Unity and Prosperity (NRPUP) leader Brian Mundubile was arrested and taken to Ibex Police Station.

Mr Kawana, who was speaking at Ibex Police Station live on his Facebook page, said the situation at the police station was calm, dismissing social media reports that Mr Mundubile was being held there.

“There is nothing happening here. It is quiet, and officers are going about their business. The claims that Mr Mundubile has been arrested and brought to Ibex Police Station are not true,” Mr Kawana said.

He accused some opposition figures and their supporters of circulating an old video of Mr Mundubile at the police station and presenting it as a current recording.

Mr Kawana said the reports had attracted scores of people to the police station, where they parked their vehicles and allegedly disrupted traffic while attempting to verify the claims.

He warned that anyone who engaged in unlawful assembly, public nuisance or activities that disrupted public order would face action from law-enforcement agencies.

“If the police move in and arrest people for public nuisance, destabilising traffic or unlawfully assembling, they should not turn around and claim that democratic space is shrinking,” he said.

Mr Kawana also urged young people not to allow themselves to be used to create confusion in the country, saying authorities would not permit any attempts to destabilise Zambia.

His remarks came as the country awaited the Electoral Commission of Zambia’s announcement of election results, which was scheduled to begin at 22:00 hours.

Mr Kawana accused the NRPUP and other unnamed opposition groups of attempting to create a chaotic situation ahead of the announcement.

“There is a government in place, and anyone who attempts to bring confusion or destabilise the country will be dealt with in accordance with the law,” he said.

And the Police who also refuted claims of Mr Mundubile’s arrest have warned that circulation of such materials is an offence punishable by law.



Election activities for the 2026 General Elections in pictures.

Bus stations, markets on demand

By Alex Maboshe

Lusaka’s central business district was today thrown into some chaos after suspected Tonse Alliance cadres allegedly began seizing control of trading spaces at several markets and bus stations.

The incidents followed NRPUP presidential candidate Brian Mundubile’s earlier address that suggested that according to the results obtained from his party’s PVT, he had won the election.

Videos circulating on social media show women traders fleeing their stalls in panic, abandoning tomatoes and other goods.

Similar disturbances were reported in other parts of the capital, including Garden House and Chipata Compound.

Police and military personnel intervened and managed to restore order in the affected areas.

Tension remains high across the country as members of the public await the Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ) to resume the official announcement of results, expected within the next 24 hours.

Wait peacefully calmly - HH

By Ruth Kambita

President Hakainde Hichilema has called on Zambians to remain peaceful, patient and patriotic as the country awaits the official outcome of the 2026 general election.

In a message posted on his Facebook page, President Hichilema said the country was continuing to receive encouraging reports of peace, unity and solidarity as votes were being counted.

“There is much in this moment to be grateful for,” he said, urging citizens to wait patiently for the official results from the institutions mandated to manage the election.

“We continue to receive encouraging results and reports of peace, unity and solidarity across our country as the votes come in. Let us remain peaceful, patient and patriotic as we await the official outcome from those entrusted with managing the vote,” he wrote.

The appeal comes as counting continues across the country.

Man jailed for stealing wagon brake shaft

By Ruth Kambita

A 37-year-old man from Kabwe has been sentenced to four years’ imprisonment with hard labour for stealing Zambia Railways Limited property.

Linus Kabinda was convicted and sentenced on August 11, 2026, with the 48-month term backdated to the date of his arrest.

The offence occurred on September 17, 2025, at around midday, when Zambia Railways

security officers intercepted Kabinda as he walked from the Zambia Railways Workshops along Mine Hospital Road towards Kabwe Railway Station.

Officers found him in possession of a wagon brake shaft be-

longing to the parastatal, valued at about US\$100. He was handed over to Chowa Police Station, where the case was investigated and successfully prosecuted, leading to his conviction and sentencing.

Zambia Railways said the sentence should serve as a warning to would-be offenders against theft and vandalism of rail materials, which are critical to the safe and efficient operation of railway services.

Reyjas Ltd in massive support for Muf soccer teams

By Benedict Tembo

Mufulira Wanderers Queens have received an assortment of football kit and equipment from Reyjas (Zambia) Limited. The donation from Reyjas includes jerseys and footballs for the Queens and a number of other sports clubs in Mufulira.

At a handover ceremony held at Shinde Stadium in Mufulira yesterday, Reyjas emphasised their commitment to supporting the development of sport in Mufulira. At the same event, Mufulira Medics and Mufulira Correctional Eagles also benefitted from Reyjas generosity. Receiving the donation on behalf of the Queens, was the

club's vice-president Hapaku Hamweene. Also in attendance were board members Vincent Chitungulu and Isaac Mumba who is in charge of the Queens. Acting Chief Executive Officer Evans Chinyanta also attended. The club expressed appreciation to Reyjas and reaf-

firmed the club's commitment to utilizing the equipment effectively and with the utmost care and ensure that it contributes to the development of players and the growth of women's football. And Reyjas Director Chrispin Kaumba indicated that the donation reflects the company's dedication to supporting sport, nurturing

young talent and largely its Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR). According to Wanderers media, representatives from Mufulira Medics FC and Mufulira Prisons Sports Club also conveyed their gratitude to Reyjas (Z) Ltd for the timely support.

Zambia pulls out of World MMA Youth championships due to poor cash flow

By Benedict Tembo

Mixed Martial Arts (MMA) Zambia has withdrawn its six fighters from next week's 2026 Youth World Championships in the United Arab Emirates due to financial constraints.

The six youth fighters were scheduled to represent Zambia at the International Mixed Martial Arts Federation (IMMAF) Youth World Championships in Abu Dhabi slated for August 16 to 23, 2026. MMA Zambia said in a statement on Thursday that despite extensive efforts to mobilise resources required, it has unfortunately been unable to secure the necessary funding within the timeframe required to ensure the team travels safely, adequately prepared and in good time for the Championships.

"This has been an extremely difficult decision, particularly considering the tremendous commitment, sacrifice and hard work demonstrated by our young athletes throughout their preparation,"

Michael Goma MMA Zambia Director – Media and Communications said. He apologised to the athletes, their families, coaches and clubs who have invested a lot into the planned trip to the World championships.

Goma also extended MMA Zambia's appreciation to all its stakeholders, including the Ministry of Youth, Sport and Arts and the National Sports Council of Zambia (NSCZ), for the continued engagement and support of the development of Mixed Martial Arts in Zambia.

"We further recognise that this period coincides with Zambia's 2026 General Election, an important national undertaking which has naturally commanded significant national attention and resources," he said.

While MMA Zambia was deeply disappointed that the young athletes will not compete on the world stage this year, Goma said the setback was not the end of their journey.

"Zambia remains fully committed to developing our youth programme and providing our young athletes with future opportunities to represent Zambia internationally," he said.

Britain's Finlay Tarling dies in Volta a Portugal accident



British cyclist Finlay Tarling has died aged 19, after a serious accident during the eighth stage of the Volta a Portugal.

Tarling is the younger brother of Netcompany-Ineos rider Josh and had raced for Great Britain on the road and track.

The Welshman was competing for the NSN Development Team, when the incident occurred on the 166.8km route from Melgaco to Fafe.

In a statement, NSN said: "We are heartbroken to announce the passing of Finlay Tarling at the Volta a Portugal today.

"Fin was a much loved member of our team but most importantly, he was a son, a brother, and a friend to so many. He will be deeply missed.

"Our deepest condolences go out to Fin's parents Michael and Dawn, his brother Josh, and everyone who was lucky enough to call Fin a friend."

In a post on X, the race organisers and the Portuguese Cycling Federation also expressed their "most heartfelt condolences to the family of Finlay Tarling, to his team-mates, to the NSN Development Team, and to all his friends and loved ones".

It added that the racing was stopped and the scheduled podium ceremony would not take place as a sign of "respect and mourning".

Portuguese president Antonio Jose Seguro added that Tarling's death had "plunged the peloton, the tournament and the host nation into mourning". BBC

Zambia Premier League kicks-off October 3

The Zambia Premier League (ZPL) has officially confirmed 3 October 2026 as the kick-off date for the 2026 Transition Season, with fixtures now released for clubs to prepare for a new phase of domestic football.

The season will be preceded by the Charity Shield on 19 September 2026, which will be played between reigning Absa Cup champions Red Arrows and league defending champions Power Dynamos

football club.

The transitional season will also feature the newly introduced the Zambia Football Association Cup (ZFA) a national knockout competition designed to bring together ZPL clubs and qualifying teams from the FAZ provincial leagues.

The introduction of the ZFA Cup will give teams from the provincial leagues an opportunity to compete on the national stage while adding another

competitive dimension to the transition season.

The Airmen are in stream B with the Kabwe Warriors, ZESCO United, Mutondo Stars

Red Arrows, Mufulira Wanderer, Green Eagles, Nkwazi FC, Roan United, Green Buffaloes and Chirundu United.

AIRMEN